
CV / Resume Guide (2026)

Introduction

A Curriculum Vitae (CV) or Resume is a professional document that summarizes an applicant's education, work experience, technical skills, achievements, certifications, research, projects, and other relevant qualifications.

Almost every university, scholarship provider, employer, and internship program requires applicants to submit a well-organized CV or Resume as part of their application.

A strong CV helps reviewers quickly understand an applicant's qualifications and suitability for a particular opportunity.

CV vs Resume

Although the terms are often used interchangeably, they have different meanings in some countries.

Curriculum Vitae (CV)

A CV is generally:

- More detailed
 - Longer
 - Includes complete academic history
 - Includes research and publications
 - Common for universities, scholarships, and academic positions
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Resume

A Resume is generally:

- Shorter
- More concise
- Tailored to a specific job
- Focuses on relevant experience

- Common for employment opportunities

Some universities use the term "Resume" even when they expect a document similar to a CV.

Applicants should always follow the institution's instructions.

Why Is a CV Important?

Admission committees and employers use a CV to evaluate:

- Educational background
- Professional experience
- Technical skills
- Leadership experience
- Research activities
- Volunteer work
- Awards and achievements
- Career progression

The CV often forms the first impression of an applicant.

Recommended Length

Typical recommendations:

Students with limited experience:

- One page

Professionals with several years of experience:

- One to two pages

Academic researchers:

- Multiple pages if necessary

Applicants should follow any page limits specified by the institution.

Recommended CV Structure

A professional CV should include the following sections.

1. Personal Information

Include:

- Full Name
- Email Address
- Phone Number
- Country of Residence
- LinkedIn Profile (optional)
- GitHub Portfolio (for technical fields)
- Portfolio Website (if available)

Do not include:

- National ID number
 - Passport number
 - Religion
 - Marital status
 - Political affiliation
 - Sensitive personal information
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2. Professional Summary

A short paragraph describing:

- Current education or occupation
- Main area of expertise
- Career interests
- Key strengths

Example topics:

- Computer Science student
- Software Engineer
- Data Scientist
- Research Assistant

3. Education

Include:

- University
- Degree
- Major
- Graduation Date
- GPA (if strong or requested)
- Relevant coursework
- Academic achievements

4. Work Experience

For each position include:

- Job Title
- Organization
- Location
- Employment dates
- Responsibilities
- Key achievements

Whenever possible, describe achievements using measurable results.

Example:

Improved application performance by 35%.

Developed a REST API serving over 5,000 requests daily.

5. Projects

Projects are especially important for students and recent graduates.

Include:

- Project Title
- Technologies Used

- Brief description
- Your role
- Key accomplishments
- GitHub repository (if available)

Examples:

- AI Assistant
 - Web Application
 - Mobile App
 - Machine Learning Project
 - Data Analysis Project
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6. Technical Skills

Examples:

Programming Languages

- Python
- Java
- C++
- JavaScript
- SQL

Frameworks

- React
- Angular
- FastAPI
- Django
- Spring Boot

Databases

- PostgreSQL
- MySQL
- MongoDB
- Supabase

Cloud Platforms

- AWS
- Azure

- Google Cloud

Developer Tools

- Git
- GitHub
- Docker
- Linux
- VS Code

Artificial Intelligence

- LangChain
- RAG
- Hugging Face
- OpenAI APIs
- TensorFlow
- PyTorch
- Scikit-learn

7. Certifications

Examples include:

- AWS Certifications
- Microsoft Certifications
- Google Certificates
- Coursera Certificates
- edX Courses
- Udemy Courses
- Professional Training Programs

Include:

- Certificate Name
- Organization
- Completion Date

8. Research Experience

If applicable:

- Research topic
 - Institution
 - Supervisor
 - Responsibilities
 - Publications
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9. Publications

Include:

- Journal Articles
 - Conference Papers
 - Research Posters
 - Technical Reports
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10. Awards and Honors

Examples:

- Scholarships
 - Academic awards
 - Programming competitions
 - Research grants
 - Dean's List
 - Innovation competitions
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11. Leadership Experience

Examples:

- Student organizations
 - Club leadership
 - Volunteer leadership
 - Event organization
 - Team management
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12. Volunteer Experience

Examples:

- NGOs
- Community service
- Student organizations
- Conferences
- Educational initiatives

Volunteer work demonstrates initiative and community engagement.

13. Languages

Examples:

Arabic — Native

English — IELTS 7.5

French — Intermediate

Applicants should specify proficiency levels where possible.

ATS-Friendly CV Guidelines

Many employers use Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS) to screen applications.

To improve ATS compatibility:

- Use standard section headings.
 - Avoid tables and text boxes.
 - Use readable fonts.
 - Submit PDF only if requested.
 - Include relevant keywords from the job description.
 - Avoid graphics that ATS software cannot read.
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Common CV Mistakes

Avoid:

- Grammar mistakes.
 - Spelling errors.
 - Poor formatting.
 - Inconsistent dates.
 - False information.
 - Missing contact information.
 - Including irrelevant experience.
 - Using an unprofessional email address.
 - Extremely long descriptions.
 - Low-quality PDF exports.
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Tailoring Your CV

Applicants should customize their CV for each application.

Examples include:

For scholarships:

- Leadership
- Community service
- Academic achievements
- Research

For software engineering:

- Programming projects
- GitHub
- Technical skills
- Internships

For research programs:

- Publications
- Laboratory work
- Research experience

For MBA programs:

- Leadership
 - Management
 - Business achievements
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Scholarship CV Tips

Strong scholarship CVs usually emphasize:

- Academic excellence
 - Leadership
 - Community engagement
 - Volunteer activities
 - Research
 - International experience
 - Awards
 - Career goals
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Frequently Asked Questions

Should I include my GPA?

Include your GPA if it is strong or if the institution specifically requests it.

Should I include high school education?

Generally, university applicants may include it if relevant. Graduate applicants usually focus on higher education unless instructed otherwise.

Should I include hobbies?

Only include hobbies if they are relevant or demonstrate valuable skills.

Can I use the same CV for every application?

It is recommended to customize your CV for each university, scholarship, or job.

Should I include references?

Only if requested.

Otherwise, references can be provided upon request.

Can AI help improve my CV?

AI can assist with grammar, formatting, keyword optimization, and identifying missing information. However, applicants are responsible for ensuring all content is accurate and reflects their real experience.

AI Verification Checklist

When reviewing a CV or Resume, an AI system should verify:

- CV uploaded successfully.
 - Personal information present.
 - Professional summary included.
 - Education section complete.
 - Work experience included (if applicable).
 - Projects described clearly.
 - Technical skills identified.
 - Certifications listed.
 - Leadership or volunteer activities included.
 - Contact information available.
 - Dates appear consistent.
 - Formatting is professional and readable.
 - No obvious missing sections.
 - Document appears ATS-friendly.
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Key Takeaways

- A CV or Resume is one of the most important documents in any academic or professional application.
- It should present accurate, organized, and relevant information tailored to the specific opportunity.
- Strong CVs emphasize measurable achievements, relevant skills, and clear structure.
- Applicants should regularly update and customize their CV to align with the requirements of each university, scholarship, or employer.
- A well-prepared CV, combined with a strong Statement of Purpose and Recommendation Letters, significantly improves the overall quality of an application.